

DIAGNOSTIC WORKBOOK

Decoding the Rs. 100 Cr Breakthrough

Readiness scorecards for each strategic
archetype — rate 1 (poor) to 10 (world-class)

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Each worksheet is designed to be used in a leadership session — not read passively. Work through the questions with your management team, using your actual financial and operational data. The answers that are hardest to write down are the ones that matter most.

BOOK FOUR · DECODING THE RS. 100 CR BREAKTHROUGH

Readiness scorecards for each strategic archetype — rate 1 (poor) to 10 (world-class)

Worksheet 4.1

OEM Specialist Readiness — Sundram Fasteners Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Switching Cost Architecture	Have we embedded into the customer's operations so deeply that replacing us costs more than our price premium?		
Zero-Defect Track Record	Do we have a documented, multi-year record of zero-defect delivery to demanding OEM customers?		
Compliance Infrastructure	Do we possess the certifications, audit records, and traceability systems required by Tier-1 OEM procurement?		
Supply Chain Integration	Can we manage VMI, EDI integration, and last-mile logistics directly to international assembly lines?		
Long-Cycle Patience	Does our cash flow and culture support 12–24 month OEM qualification sales cycles?		
Metallurgical / Technical Depth	Do we possess proprietary process knowledge that competitors cannot replicate by buying the same machines?		

THE DIAGNOSIS

Any metric below 7 represents a structural gap that must be addressed before this archetype can be successfully executed. The gap with the lowest score is your First Domino. Use the final column to build a specific, time-bound capability

roadmap.

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Worksheet 4.2

Contract Manufacturing Engine Readiness — Dixon Technologies Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Working Capital Velocity	Can we sustain the cash cycle of manufacturing large volumes before payment terms arrive?		
Cost Structure Rigour	Is our cost structure lean enough to generate attractive returns at 3–5% EBITDA margins?		
Brand Agnosticism	Are we genuinely comfortable building other companies' brands with zero ambition to launch our own?		
Line Changeover Speed	Can we switch from Brand A to Brand B production rapidly without quality degradation?		
Information Barrier Systems	Do we have certified systems protecting each client's IP and commercial data from all other clients?		
Policy / PLI Alignment	Are we positioned to capture government incentives that structurally advantage domestic contract manufacturing?		

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Worksheet 4.3

Import Substitution Readiness — AIA Engineering Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Technical Equivalence	Can we match the imported product's performance specifications at every critical parameter — with documentation?	— — —	
Total Cost Advantage	Is our total delivered cost — including duty savings and lead time — significantly lower than the import?	— — —	
Customer Trial Willingness	Are target buyers willing to qualify us as an approved alternative, or locked into the imported source?	— — —	
Application Engineering Capability	Can we send engineers inside the customer's operation to model the TCO saving — not just quote a price?	— — —	
Long Sales Cycle Capital	Can we fund a 12–18 month qualification cycle before the first significant revenue arrives?	— — —	
Regulatory and Standards Fluency	Do we understand the certification landscape required to be accepted as an import substitute?	— — —	

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Worksheet 4.4

Commodity to Brand Readiness — Astral Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Hidden Influencer Access	Have we identified and built relationships with the person who actually chooses the product — not just the cheque-writer?		
Technological Wedge	Do we possess a superior product technology that gives us a genuine reason to command a premium?		
Consumer Marketing Capability	Does our leadership team have both the mindset and budget to invest in sustained brand-building?		
Distribution Independence	Can we reach the end decision-maker without being completely dependent on the distributor's cooperation?		
B2C Empathy	Does our leadership team genuinely understand consumer psychology, aesthetics, and retail presentation?		
Quality Control at Brand Level	Does the factory floor possess the quality control required to back a premium brand promise at scale?		

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Worksheet 4.5

White Label Ecosystem Readiness — Amber Enterprises Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
ODM vs. OEM Mindset	Are we capable of presenting a complete engineered solution — not 'send us your drawing and we will make it'?	— — —	
Backward Integration Depth	Do we manufacture the sub-components our clients currently buy from third-party suppliers?	— — —	
Physics-Based Location Advantage	Is our product heavy, bulky, or fragile enough that local manufacturing creates a structural freight advantage?	— — —	
Design Ownership	Do we own the CAD drawings and IP of at least some of the products we manufacture?	— — —	
NDA and IP Discipline	Do we have certified systems to protect each client's formulations, designs, and commercial information?	— — —	
Balance Sheet Tolerance	Can we tolerate the heavy capital requirements of backward integration?	— — —	

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Worksheet 4.6

Distribution Power Readiness — KEI Industries Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Dealer ROI Engineering	Do we know the exact return on investment per square foot our product generates for a dealer — and is it best-in-class?	— — —	
Replenishment Speed	Can we replenish a dealer's stock within 24 hours anywhere in our target geography?	— — —	
Influencer Programme	Have we built a systematic loyalty programme for the person who installs or specifies our product?	— — —	
Retail vs. Institutional Balance	Do we have a healthy mix of fast-paying retail revenue and volume-generating institutional revenue?	— — —	
Working Capital Discipline	Do we have the discipline to walk away from institutional tenders with abusive payment terms?	— — —	
Decentralised Warehousing	Do we have regional inventory positioned ahead of demand — not shipped from a single central warehouse?	— — —	

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Worksheet 4.7

Cost Leadership Readiness — Relaxo Footwears Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Volume Commitment	Do we have the demand commitments required to justify building mega-scale, single-product dedicated lines?		
Standardisation Discipline	Are we willing to limit our SKU range to a narrow, optimised set — rejecting all customisation requests?		
Raw Material Leverage	Are we buying raw materials in volumes large enough to access true bulk-purchase pricing advantages?		
OEE Performance	Is our Overall Equipment Effectiveness above 80% — the minimum threshold for structural cost leadership?		
Brand Investment Willingness	Are we willing to spend significantly on consumer marketing to guarantee the volume that feeds the factories?		
Unorganised Sector Readiness	Are we genuinely equipped to compete against informal, unregistered competitors on total delivered cost?		

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Global Niche Readiness — Vinati Organics Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Niche Focus Tolerance	Can our leadership team commit to a single product or application — and walk away from everything else?		
Process Innovation Capability	Do we have the R&D; infrastructure and culture to continuously improve our manufacturing process?		
Export Infrastructure	Can we manage multi-country customer relationships, currency hedging, and international logistics reliably?		
Capacity Pre-emption Appetite	Are we willing to build capacity ahead of current demand to deter potential competitors?		
International Regulatory Mastery	Do we understand and comply with the certifications required by our target global buyers?		
Long-Term Capital View	Does our ownership structure support a 5–7 year investment horizon before market dominance is achieved?		

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Distribution Platform Expansion Readiness — Polycab Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Anchor Product Dominance	Do we have genuine, unchallenged shelf-space dominance in our core product category with the target dealer network?		
Channel Trust Capital	Have we built such a reliable track record with dealers that they would stock a new, untested product on our recommendation?		
Brand Transfer Capability	Is our brand perception in our core category strong enough to transfer credibility to an adjacent category?		
Category Management Capability	Can we manage the complexity of multiple product categories simultaneously?		
Cross-Category Incentive Architecture	Have we designed an incentive structure that rewards dealers for growing their total wallet share with us?		
Quality Quarantine Capability	If a new category fails in quality, can we isolate the failure without damaging core category trust?		

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Value Chain Climb Readiness — PG Electroplast Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Capability Stacking Patience	Does our management team have the discipline to reinvest profits into adjacent capabilities rather than dividends?	— — —	
Adjacent Capability Mapping	Have we mapped the next two rungs of the value chain and assessed the gap required to reach each? Can our culture absorb	— — —	
Complexity Tolerance	fundamentally new manufacturing technologies without losing quality in existing operations?	— — —	
Customer Lock-In Architecture	Are we building integration with customers' engineering and procurement systems that makes substitution progressively harder?	— — —	
Revenue per Unit Ambition	Are we tracking revenue per unit as a strategic metric — and is it increasing year on year?	— — —	
NPI Programme Capability	Can we run New Product Introduction programmes across mechanical, electronic, and compliance disciplines?	— — —	

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Strategic Reinvention Readiness — Havells India Archetype

READINESS METRIC	WHAT THIS MEASURES	SCORE	WHAT NEEDS TO CHANGE
Willingness to Cannibalise	If transitioning to a new strategic identity meant permanently abandoning the legacy model, would leadership commit?		
Consumer Psychology Empathy	Does our leadership understand consumer psychology, aesthetics, and visual merchandising?		
Premium Brand Investment	Are we willing to commit sustained marketing investment — not a one-year experiment — to build brand pull?		
Visual Merchandising Capability	Can we design, fund, and manage a premium retail experience that matches our brand promise?		
Quality Control at Brand Level	If we doubled brand awareness, would quality control hold at the same standard under increased volume?		
Divestment Courage	If a diversification is destroying focus, do we have the boardroom discipline to divest — as Havells did with Sylvania?		

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The diagnostic questions in this workbook are designed to be worked through in a leadership session. The answers that are hardest to write down — the ones that require looking at actual data rather than intuition — are the ones that matter most.

If working through these worksheets has surfaced a strategic question your leadership team cannot yet answer clearly — about where to compete, how to invest, or what to test before committing capital — that question is where the advisory work begins.

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